

Gaetano Scaduto

Postdoctoral Researcher

Born Feb 25th, 1999 in Agrigento, Italy

Currently residing in Antwerp, Belgium

🌐 gaetanoscaduto.quarto.pub/home/ | Updated: May. 6, 2026

Appointments

POSTDOCTORAL RESEARCHER

OCT 2025-PRESENT

Erasmus University Rotterdam. Rotterdam. The Netherlands.

Erasmus School of Social and Behavioural Sciences, Department of Public Administration and Sociology (DPAS), Governance and Pluralism.

Working on the project [CLIMEANING](#) (PI: Willem De Koster).

THESIS SUPERVISOR

MAR 2026-PRESENT

Erasmus University Rotterdam. Rotterdam. The Netherlands.

Erasmus School of Social and Behavioural Sciences, Department of Psychology, Education, and Child Studies (DPECS).

First supervisor of 13 bachelor theses.

(VOLUNTARY) FELLOW

SEP 2025-PRESENT

University of Antwerp, Antwerp, Belgium.

Faculty of Social Sciences, Department of Political Science.

Collaborating in the activities of the [“Media, Movement and Politics” \(M2P\)](#) research group and the [NOTLIKEUS](#) project.

VISITING FELLOW

MAR 2026-APR 2026

Collegio Carlo Alberto, Turin, Italy.

TEACHING ASSISTANT IN PUBLIC POLICIES

OCT 2023-SEP 2025

University of Milan-Bicocca, Milan, Italy

BS in Organization Science

More than 16 hours of in-class teaching, in addition to other duties

TEACHING ASSISTANT IN MATHEMATICS

NOV 2023-SEP 2025

University of Milan-Bicocca, Milan, Italy

BS in Organization Science

More than 16 hours of in-class teaching, in addition to other duties

Education

PH.D. STUDENT IN ANALYSIS OF SOCIAL AND ECONOMIC PROCESSES

NOV 2022-FEB 2026

University of Milan-Bicocca, Milan, Italy

Supervisors: Fedra Negri (Unimib), Delia Baldassarri (New York University).

Thesis title: “Thinking About Politics: An Experimental Inquiry into the Mental Associations between Political and Apolitical Traits and Their Social Consequences in Italy”

Final evaluation: Excellent

VISITING PH.D. STUDENT

FEB 2024-AUG 2025

University of Antwerp, Antwerp, Belgium

Supervisor: Stefaan Walgrave

Collaborating in the activities of the “[Media, Movement and Politics](#)” (M2P) research group and the [NOTLIKEUS](#) project as a visiting researcher during my Ph.D. at the University of Milan Bicocca

MASTER’S DEGREE IN POLITICAL AND PUBLIC COMMUNICATION

SEP 2020-JUL 2022

University of Turin, Turin, Italy

Thesis supervisor: Moreno Mancosu

Thesis title: “A country of upbeat songs while there is death outside? Analysis of Italian politicians’ visual communication on Instagram during the Covid-19 pandemic”

Final grade: 110/110 with honors, special mention, and rights of publication (*dignità di stampa*).

BACHELOR’S DEGREE IN MATHEMATICS FOR ENGINEERING

SEP 2017-JUL 2020

Polytechnic University of Turin, Turin, Italy

Thesis supervisor: Giacomo Como

Thesis title: “Social Choice Theory”

Final grade: 110/110

HIGH SCHOOL DIPLOMA

SEP 2012-JUL 2017

Liceo Classico “Empedocle”, Agrigento, Italy

Final grade: 100/100 with honors

Summer Schools, Winter Schools, and Short Courses

THE SUMMER INSTITUTES IN COMPUTATIONAL SOCIAL SCIENCE, UNIVERSITY OF BOLOGNA

JUN 2024

2-week summer school on computational methods, with competitive selection process.

Various teachers.

ESSEX SUMMER SCHOOL IN SOCIAL SCIENCE DATA ANALYSIS, UNIVERSITY OF ESSEX

JUL-AUG 2023

Confirmatory Factor Analysis and Structural Equation Modeling

Essex, UK

Teachers: Prof. Peter Schmidt (University of Giessen), & Dr. Daniel Seddig (University of Cologne)

ESSEX SUMMER SCHOOL IN SOCIAL SCIENCE DATA ANALYSIS, UNIVERSITY OF ESSEX

JUL-AUG 2023

Causal Inference and Experiments in Social Sciences

Essex, UK

Teachers: Dr. Ryan T. Moore (American University)

SISP - ITALIAN POLITICAL SCIENCE SOCIETY

SEP. 2023

Crash Course in Text Analysis

Genoa, Italy

Teachers: Dr. Silvia Decadri (University of Milan)

Publications

BOOKS

1. **Scaduto, G.** Thinking About Politics: Political Stereotypes, Projections, and Their Social Consequences in Italy. Book manuscript. Contract signed with Palgrave MacMillan. Forthcoming (2027).

2025

10. **Scaduto, G.**, Negri, F., Decadri, S. It's the Homophily, Stupid: How Apolitical Similarities Affect Political Conversations. *Political Behavior*. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s11109-025-10102-x>
9. **Scaduto, G.** Politicultural Linking: Inferences between Political and Apolitical Traits. *Public Opinion Quarterly*, 89(3). <https://doi.org/10.1093/poq/nfafo47>.
8. Decadri, S., Mancosu, M., Negri, F., **Scaduto, G.** Aligning Emotions: A Comparative Analysis of Text and Imagery by European Party Leaders on Instagram. *The International Journal of Press/Politics*. <https://doi.org/10.1177/19401612251339107>
7. Respi, C., Gui, M., **Scaduto, G.**, Serini, M., Pizzul, D., Gerosa, T., & Lutz, C. Lower Cynicism, Not Higher Literacy, Promotes Protective Behavior: Exploring the "privacy exception" in the Digital Inequality Framework. *Social Science Computer Review*. <https://doi.org/10.1177/08944393251341201>

2024

6. **Scaduto, G.**, Negri, F. The Pundit Paradox: Exploring the Mismatch between Supply and Demand in Italian Political Talk Show Guests. *Comunicazione Politica*. <https://www.rivisteweb.it/doi/10.3270/115244>
5. **Scaduto, G.**, Negri, F. Food for (political) thought: political inferences from apolitical cues and their social consequences in Italy. *South European Society and Politics*. 29(1), 79-108. <https://doi.org/10.1080/13608746.2024.2411539>
4. Mancosu, M., **Scaduto, G.** Crowds and Smiles: Visual Opportunity Structures and the Communication of European Political Leaders During the COVID-19 Pandemic. *Mass Communication and Society*: 1-26. <https://doi.org/10.1080/15205436.2024.2351980>

2023

3. Bertero, A., **Scaduto, G.** A midsummer night's dream: political communication during the Italian 2022 electoral campaign. *Italian Journal of Electoral Studies QOE-IJES*, 86(1), 13-28. <https://doi.org/10.36253/qoe-14224>

2022

2. **Scaduto, G.**, Mancosu, M. Lacrime di coccodrillo? Variazioni nel contenuto visuale su Instagram dei politici populisti e mainstream durante la pandemia. *Comunicazione politica*, 23(2), 255-276. <https://www.rivisteweb.it/doi/10.3270/104851>
1. **Scaduto, G.** Gli algoritmi di computer vision: una guida all'uso per le scienze politiche e sociali. *Polis*, 36(2), 315-332. <https://www.rivisteweb.it/doi/10.1424/104525>

BOOK CHAPTERS

2024

1. Negri, F., **Scaduto, G.** Le «politologhe» e i «politologi» tra scienza e dibattito pubblico. In Verzichelli, L. *La Scienza Politica Italiana, 50 anni dopo*. Il Mulino.

R&Rs/UNDER REVIEW

Scaduto, G., Negri, F., Decadri, S. Ideology at First Sight: A Comparative Study of Ideological Stereotypes in 4 European Countries. R&R in *International Journal of Public Opinion Research*.

Goovaerts, I., Tsoulou-Malakoudi, A., **Scaduto, G.**, Feitosa, F., Lefevere, J. Divided Beyond Politics: How Perceptions of Non-Political Differences Are Linked to Affective Polarization Among Citizens. R&R in *Electoral Studies*

Tsoulou-Malakoudi, A., Goovaerts, I., **Scaduto, G.**, Van Erkel, P., Walgrave, S. Political others are perceived as non-politically different. R&R in *European Journal of Political Research*.

Decadri, S., Negri, F., **Scaduto, G.** Visual Conjoint Experiments in Social-Scientific Research: A Semi-Systematic Review and a Protocol Blueprint for Cross-Country Applications. R&R in *Quality & Quantity*.

Scaduto, G., Valeriani, A. It Takes Two to Trust: Multi-modal Experimental Evidence of News Creators' Influence on Trust-Based Decisions. Under Review in *International Journal of Press/Politics*
Preprint available [here](#)

Negri, F., Decadri, S., **Scaduto, G.** A Visual Conjoint Experiment on Ideological Inferences from Politicians' Instagram Profiles.
Under Review in *Political Behavior*

Valeriani, A., Garusi, D., **Scaduto, G.**, Splendore, S. News Efficacy as a Mediator between Expectations and Trust in Journalism. Empirical evidence from Italy.
Under Review in *Communication Research*

WORK-IN-PROGRESS

Scaduto, G., Kemmers, R., de Koster, W. What does Climate Change mean to you? A Focus Group Study in Italy.
Submitted/In Submission
Scheduled for presentation in *Dag van de Sociologie 2026*, *ASA 2026*

Scaduto, G., Nijs, T., de Koster, W., Negri, F. Network Heterogeneity in European Multiparty Contexts: Direct and Secondary Associations with Ideology-based Affective Evaluations.
Submitted/In Submission
Scheduled for presentation in *Dag van de Sociologie 2026*, *Politologenetmaal 2026*, *ASA 2026*

Scaduto, G. Chapter 11. Party Communication and the Role of Images (Visual Analysis). In Close, C., Legein, T. Researching party politics Data, methods and (good) practices. Forthcoming in 2027.

Negri, F., Decadri, S., **Scaduto, G.** A Visual Conjoint Experiment on Trust Dynamics involving politicians on Instagram.
Submitted/In Submission

Scaduto, G., Bertero, A., Valeriani, A. AI and political communication, a correlational study in Italy
In writing

DATASETS (PUBLICLY AVAILABLE)

2. Political inferences from apolitical cues: food-based political inferences in Italy.
Scaduto, Gaetano [Producer]. Negri, Fedra [Producer]. Mancosu, Moreno [Producer]. UniData - Bicocca Data Archive, Milan. Study Number SN248. Data file version 1.0 doi: [10.71732/RMEP03](https://doi.org/10.71732/RMEP03)
1. *Citizens and value of digital data*.
Respi, Chiara [Producer]. Legnante, Guido [Producer]. Gui, Marco [Producer]. Pizzul, Dario [Producer]. Gaia, Alessandra [Producer]. Sala, Emanuela [Producer]. **Scaduto, Gaetano [Producer]**. UniData - Bicocca Data Archive, Milan. Study Number SN247. Data file version 1.0 doi:[10.20366/unimib/unidata/SN247-1.0](https://doi.org/10.20366/unimib/unidata/SN247-1.0)

Conferences, Workshops, and Seminars

25. European Consortium of Political Research (ECPR) Conference 2026, Krakow, Poland, 8-11 September 2026 (accepted, registered).
24. 2026 Conference of the Italian Political Science Society (SISP). Trento, 3-5 September 2026 (accepted, registered).
23. American Sociological Association Conference 2026. New York, United States, 7-11 August 2026 (accepted, registered).
22. Politicologenetmaal 2026. Gent, Belgium, 11-12 June 2026 (accepted, registered).
21. Dag van de Sociologie 2026. Antwerp, Belgium, 26 May 2026 (accepted, registered).
20. *"It Takes Two to Trust: Multi-modal Experimental Evidence of Newsmakers' Influence on Trust-Based Choices"*. Collegio Carlo Alberto. Turin, Italy. 8 March 2026.
19. *"The Visual Politics of Populism"*. PRIN [Italian Ministry of University and Research grant] 2022 Final Event. Online event. 6 November 2025.
18. 2025 Workshop Survey Experiments in the Social Sciences. Amsterdam Center for Inequality Studies (AMCIS). Amsterdam, The Netherlands. 1-2 October 2025.
17. 2025 Conference of the Italian Political Science Society (SISP). Naples, 4-6 September 2025.
16. European Consortium of Political Research (ECPR) Conference 2025, Thessaloniki, Greece, 26-29 Aug 2025
15. European Survey Research Association (ESRA) Conference 2025, Utrecht, The Netherlands, 14-18 July 2025
14. 2025 Conference of the Italian Political Communication Association (ASSOCOMPOL). Milan, 4-6 July 2025.
13. European Political Science Association (EPSA) Conference 2025, Madrid, Spain, 26-28 June 2025
12. Politicologenetmaal 2025, Groningen, The Netherlands, 12-13 June
11. PolMeth Europe 2025, London, UK, 7-9 Apr 2025
10. First MethodsNET Conference. Louvain-La-Neuve, Belgium, 31 Oct-1 Nov 2024.
9. 2024 Workshop Survey Experiments in the Social Sciences. Amsterdam Center for Inequality Studies (AMCIS). Amsterdam, The Netherlands. 24 October 2024.
8. 10th conference of the International Journal of Press/Politics. Edinburgh, 17-18 October 2024.
7. 2024 Conference of the Italian Political Science Society (SISP). Trieste, 12-14 September. Additionally chaired and organized two panels on "Survey Experiments in Political Science"
6. 2024 Conference of the Italian Political Communication Association (ASSOCOMPOL). Catania, 30 May-1 June.
5. 2024 CompText Conference (COMPTXT), Amsterdam, The Netherlands, 2-4 May.
4. SPS Seminar: "Picturing Politics? Exploring the mental images of partisans and ideologues shaped by cultural consumption choices", University of Milan, 17 January 2024.
3. 2023 Conference of the Italian Political Science Society (SISP). Genoa, 14-16 September.
2. 2023 Conference of the European Consortium for Political Research (ECPR). Prague, 4-8 September.
1. 2023 Conference of the Italian Political Communication Association (ASSOCOMPOL). Turin, 8-10 June.

Guest Lectures/Short Courses

7. "Introduction to R". Crash course during the Metrisp Crash Course Day. SISP 2026 Conference. Trento, 2 September 2026 (appointed).
Teaching material is available [here](#).
 6. "How to replicate an experimental study?". Allievi program in Social and Political Sciences (Course of Applied Statistics to Social and Political Sciences). Spring semester. 9 March 2026.
 5. "Thinking about Politics". MA in Political Communication, University of Antwerp. Fall Semester, 2025.
 4. "A practical introduction to the statistical software R for the analysis of electoral data". BA in Organization Sciences, University of Milan-Bicocca, Fall semester, 2023.
Teaching material is available [here](#).
 3. "Problems with collective decision-making: Condorcet's paradox, strategic misreporting, and Arrow's theorem". BA in Organization Sciences, University of Milan-Bicocca, Fall semester, 2023.
Teaching material is available [here](#).
 2. "Political polarization and the state of the art regarding research on political inferences from apolitical cues". BA in Organization Sciences, University of Milan-Bicocca, Spring semester, 2023.
You can download the slides [here](#).
 1. "An introduction to linear regression". BA in Organization Sciences, University of Milan-Bicocca, Spring semester, 2023.
You can download the material I produced (a medium-length document presenting the general topic) [here](#).
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Editorial Activities

REVIEWER FOR:

International Journal of Public Opinion Research, Canadian Journal of Political Science, Comunicazione Politica.

Media Outreach

RADIO

[Buongiorno InBlu 18/11/2025](#), Radio InBlu 2000.

[Buongiorno InBlu 23/01/2025](#), Radio InBlu 2000.

[Buongiorno InBlu 25/10/2024](#), Radio InBlu 2000.

ONLINE MEDIA

["Talk-show politici, lo specchio di un'Italia polarizzata"](#) (with Negri F., in Italian). LaVoce.info. January 2025.

["Ze zijn niet zoals wij": hoe kiezers kijken naar andere kiezers'](#) (with Tsoulou-Malakoudi, A. & Goovaerts, I., in Dutch). Samenleving & Politiek. December 2024.

["What your menu choice says about your politics"](#) (with Negri F.). The Loop. October 2024.

["Dimmi cosa mangi e ti dirò che partito voti"](#) (with Negri F., in Italian). LaVoce.info. October 2024.

Awards, Grants, and Memberships

AWARDS

Best paper from a Junior Researcher 2023

Awarded by the Italian Political Communication Association (ASSOCOMPOL) for the best paper presented in the 2023 conference. The prize refers to *“Food for (political) thought: investigating factors and behaviors associated with political inferences from apolitical cues in Italy”* (with F. Negri)

GRANTS AND SCHOLARSHIPS

Conference Fee Waiver for the International Journal of Press/Politics 2024 conference - 300€

“Mini-scholarship” to take part in the 2024 Conference. Italian Political Science Association (SISP) - 200€

Ph.D. Scholarship University of Milan Bicocca, Department of Sociology and Social Research - 16,243.00€ per year for three years

Ph.D. Scholarship University of Trento, Department of Sociology and Social Research (Declined to accept Ph.D. scholarship at UNIMIB)

Scholarship - Excellence Project 2022, Department of Culture, Politics and Society - University of Turin - 1500€

Study prize 2021, Renato Einaudi University College of Turin - 1500€

Study prize 2019, Renato Einaudi University College of Turin - 2500€

Scholarship by EDISU Piemonte (Regional Agency for Educational Rights) 2021. Awarded through the combination of (higher) academic performance and (lower) parental income - 5100€

Scholarship by EDISU Piemonte (Regional Agency for Educational Rights) 2020. Awarded through the combination of (higher) academic performance and (lower) parental income - 5100€

Scholarship by EDISU Piemonte (Regional Agency for Educational Rights) 2019. Awarded through the combination of (higher) academic performance and (lower) parental income - 5100€

Scholarship by EDISU Piemonte (Regional Agency for Educational Rights) 2018. Awarded through the combination of (higher) academic performance and (lower) parental income - 5100€

Scholarship by EDISU Piemonte (Regional Agency for Educational Rights) 2017. Awarded through the combination of (higher) academic performance and (lower) parental income - 5100€

MEMBERSHIPS

Member of ASSOCOMPOL (Italian Political Communication Association) [Since 2024]

Member of SISP, (Società Italiana di Scienza Politica - Italian Political Science Society) [Since 2023]

Member of ECPR Affective Polarization Standing Group [Since 2023]

Other professional experiences

ACADEMIC

Research Collaborator, *University of Milan-Bicocca*, Italy

Sep 2023-Aug 2025

Involvement in the activities related to the project “VIPOP - The visual politics of populism” (PI: Mattia Zulianello, UniTS; Vice PIs: Fedra Negri, Unimib; Luigi Curini, Unimi). These activities included (but were not limited to):

- a) Designing a survey fielded in 4 European countries
- b) Designing survey experiments

- c) Working with computational methods to download and analyze politicians' social media posts
- d) Managing the relationship between the working group and the survey company
- e) Supervising the translation and cultural adaptation of the survey in multiple national contexts

Research Collaborator, *University of Milan-Bicocca*, Italy Aug-Dec 2023

Analysis and management of survey data for research purposes for the project "VDATA - The Value of Digital Data"

Conference Assistant, *European Survey Research Association*, Milan, Italy Jul 2023

Assisted in the activities related to the 2023 European Survey Research Association Conference.

Research Fellow, *Collegio Carlo Alberto*, Turin May-Jun 2022

Data gathering on the media outlets of 47 countries with research purposes. Data analysis on survey results (Stata, R). Data entry and data management (Excel).

EXTRA-ACADEMIC

Junior Research Specialist and Deputy Campaign Coordinator, *Social Changes, Inc.*, Rome, Italy 2022

- a) Contributed to organizing and coordinating multiple campaigns for the 2022 political and municipal elections in Italy.
- b) Managed the relationship with companies providing media analysis services (WebPredict) and provided insights on how to use media analysis for strategic purposes during the campaign.
- c) Coordinated and conducted research on advertisements and media profiles of adversarial campaigns.
- d) Created electoral databases useful for electoral insights (R). Provided training on digital strategies (WhatsApp-Telegram Cascades) to staff members of multiple campaigns.
- e) Coordinated and wrote a daily newsletter, including press reviews and campaign insights with strategic consideration.
- f) Contributed to the construction of targets for social media political advertisements.

Part-Time Receptionist, *Renato Einaudi University College*, Turin 2021-2022

Supervised on the general life and activity of the college. Front office relations. Management of relations with the administration of the college and maintenance, cleaning, and organizational figures.

Students' Tutor, *Renato Einaudi University College*, Turin 2021-2022

Mediation between the college administration and its students. Conflict resolution. Support in first arrival orientation. Management of students' educational plan.

Skills

LANGUAGES

Italian, Native.

English, C2.

Dutch, C1 speaking, B2 writing, exam for C1 writing scheduled for June 2026.

CODING SKILLS/SOFTWARES

R, Advanced; **C**, Proficient; **SQL**, Proficient; **LaTeX**, Proficient; **Microsoft Office package**, Proficient; **Python**, Intermediate; **C++**, Beginner; **Stata**, Beginner; **Html**, Beginner; **Shiny**, Beginner; **Javascript**, Beginner; **Matlab**, Beginner

Academic References

Willem de Koster. Erasmus University Rotterdam. dekoster@essb.eur.nl

Stefaan Walgrave. University of Antwerp. stefaan.walgrave@uantwerpen.be

If not available, feel free to contact:

Delia Baldassarri. New York University. delia.b@nyu.edu

Fedra Negri. University of Milan Bicocca. fedra.negri@unimib.it

Moreno Mancosu. University of Turin. moreno.mancosu@unito.it